



Qualification Pack

Topiary Garden Artist

QP Code: CUTM/AGR/Q0801

Version: 1.0

NSQF Level: 4

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Qualification Pack

Contents

CUTM/AGR/Q0801: Topiary Garden Artist	3
<i>Brief Job Description</i>	3
Applicable National Occupational Standards (NOS)	3
<i>Compulsory NOS</i>	3
<i>Qualification Pack (QP) Parameters</i>	3
CUTM/AGR/N0801: Introduction to plants used in Topiary Gardening and Gardening Tools	5
CUTM/AGR/N0802: Soil Management Practices	9
CUTM/AGR/N0803: Plants and Products for Topiary Making	13
CUTM/AGR/N0804: Plant Propagation Techniques	17
CUTM/AGR/N0805: Topiary Designing and Preservation	21
CUTM/AGR/N0806: Yard Waste Management	25
CUTM/VSQ/N7803: Maintain Health and Safety at Work Place.	29
DGT/VSQ/N0101: Employability Skills (30 Hours)	34
Assessment Guidelines and Weightage	39
<i>Assessment Guidelines</i>	39
<i>Assessment Weightage</i>	40
Acronyms	42
Glossary	43



Qualification Pack

CUTM/AGR/Q0801: Topiary Garden Artist

Brief Job Description

The individual is responsible to understand quality parameters of Topiary Garden Artist. Trainee able to disseminate the knowledge and skills related to topiary to new generations of gardeners. Handle different artistic aspects of topiary techniques. Add value to the garden, parks and office gardens. Outcomes of topiary maintenance encompass the preservation of design, plant health, long-term sustainability of living sculptures and maintain their aesthetic and artistic roles in the garden or landscape in their specific environments. Understand the roles and responsibilities as topiary trainer experts.

Personal Attributes

A Topiary Garden Artist should be creative, patient, and detail-oriented, with a strong aesthetic sense and love for plants. They must possess good hand-eye coordination, physical stamina, and spatial awareness. Discipline, precision, and a passion for garden design are essential, along with the ability to work independently or in teams.

Applicable National Occupational Standards (NOS)

Compulsory NOS:

1. [CUTM/AGR/N0801: Introduction to plants used in Topiary Gardening and Gardening Tools](#)
2. [CUTM/AGR/N0802: Soil Management Practices](#)
3. [CUTM/AGR/N0803: Plants and Products for Topiary Making](#)
4. [CUTM/AGR/N0804: Plant Propagation Techniques](#)
5. [CUTM/AGR/N0805: Topiary Designing and Preservation](#)
6. [CUTM/AGR/N0806: Yard Waste Management](#)
7. [CUTM/VSQ/N7803: Maintain Health and Safety at Work Place.](#)
8. [DGT/VSQ/N0101: Employability Skills \(30 Hours\)](#)

Qualification Pack (QP) Parameters

Sector	Agriculture
Sub-Sector	Horticulture

Qualification Pack

Occupation	Gardener
Country	India
NSQF Level	4
Credits	14
Aligned to NCO/ISCO/ISIC Code	NSQF/NCrF
Minimum Educational Qualification & Experience	12th grade Pass with NA of experience OR Previous relevant Qualification of NSQF Level (3.5) with 1.5 years of experience relevant experience OR Previous relevant Qualification of NSQF Level (3) with 3 Years of experience relevant experience
Minimum Level of Education for Training in School	10th Class
Pre-Requisite License or Training	NA
Minimum Job Entry Age	18 Years
Last Reviewed On	NA
Next Review Date	21/10/2027
NSQC Approval Date	22/10/2024
Version	1.0
Reference code on NQR	QG-04-AG-03353-2024-V1-CUTM
NQR Version	1.0

Qualification Pack

CUTM/AGR/N0801: Introduction to plants used in Topiary Gardening and Gardening Tools

Description

This NOS introduces learners to topiary-friendly plants and the tools required for sculpting and maintaining them. It covers plant characteristics, tool identification, and safe handling procedures, enabling learners to prepare effectively for artistic plant shaping.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- The scope includes identifying suitable topiary plants, understanding their care requirements, and mastering the use of essential gardening tools. Learners will gain foundational knowledge of horticulture, safety protocols, and tool upkeep necessary for shaping and maintaining decorative plant forms.

Elements and Performance Criteria

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Introduction to the suitable plants for making topiary and role of Topiary Gardener
- PC2.** Identify various types of garden tools
- PC3.** Know the use of power tools and hand tools.
- PC4.** Maintenance of the equipment.
- PC5.** Know about the safety measures in using tools and equipment.
- PC6.** Inculcate the knowledge regarding the roles and responsibilities of Topiary Gardener.

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** different types of plants suitable for topiary.
- KU2.** evergreen species commonly used in shaping.
- KU3.** the basic principles of plant aesthetics and growth habits.
- KU4.** climate adaptability of topiary plant species.
- KU5.** tool types: shears, pruners, secateurs, loppers, etc.
- KU6.** the maintenance techniques of gardening tools.
- KU7.** the safety precautions in handling sharp tools.
- KU8.** the seasonal requirements for pruning.
- KU9.** the basic botany related to leaf retention and regeneration.
- KU10.** signs of disease and pest issues in topiary plants.

Generic Skills (GS)



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User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Identify and classify plants for various topiary shapes.
- GS2.** Safely use gardening tools for trimming and maintenance.
- GS3.** Maintain and sharpen gardening equipment.
- GS4.** Demonstrate proper posture and safety during trimming.
- GS5.** Handle and dispose of plant waste properly.
- GS6.** Communicate effectively about plant types and tool use.
- GS7.** Maintain a logbook of tool usage and maintenance.
- GS8.** Follow eco-friendly gardening practices.
- GS9.** Work with precision and attention to detail.
- GS10.** Organize tools and materials efficiently before use.

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
	30	40	-	30
PC1. Introduction to the suitable plants for making topiary and role of Topiary Gardener	5	-	-	5
PC2. Identify various types of garden tools	5	-	-	5
PC3. Know the use of power tools and hand tools.	5	15	-	5
PC4. Maintenance of the equipment.	5	15	-	5
PC5. Know about the safety measures in using tools and equipment.	5	10	-	5
PC6. Inculcate the knowledge regarding the roles and responsibilities of Topiary Gardener.	5	-	-	5
NOS Total	30	40	-	30



Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	CUTM/AGR/N0801
NOS Name	Introduction to plants used in Topiary Gardening and Gardening Tools
Sector	Agriculture
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Gardener
NSQF Level	4
Credits	1
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	22/10/2024
Next Review Date	21/10/2027
NSQF Clearance Date	22/10/2024

Qualification Pack

CUTM/AGR/N0802: Soil Management Practices

Description

This NOS focuses on soil preparation and management techniques essential for healthy plant growth in topiary gardening. It includes understanding soil types, fertility, water retention, and sustainable enhancement practices.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Covers soil testing, composting, nutrient management, pH balancing, and eco-friendly methods for improving and maintaining soil health. Learners will develop skills for preparing optimal growing conditions in garden settings.

Elements and Performance Criteria

Understanding the different quality parameters associated with soil testing, land preparation for Topiary gardening

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- | | |
|-------------|---|
| PC1. | Soil testing methods. |
| PC2. | Mineral content of soil samples. |
| PC3. | Land preparation methods for topiary plant propagation. |

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- | | |
|--------------|--|
| KU1. | different soil types and textures. |
| KU2. | Learn soil pH and its influence on plant growth. |
| KU3. | organic and inorganic amendments. |
| KU4. | composting and mulching benefits. |
| KU5. | Recognize signs of poor soil health. |
| KU6. | water retention and drainage properties. |
| KU7. | nutrient cycling and deficiency indicators. |
| KU8. | Know methods for testing soil fertility. |
| KU9. | about soil erosion control. |
| KU10. | eco-sustainable soil improvement practices. |

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- | | |
|-------------|-----------------------------------|
| GS1. | Collect and analyze soil samples. |
|-------------|-----------------------------------|



Qualification Pack

- GS2.** Adjust pH using safe additives.
- GS3.** Mix and apply compost to enhance fertility.
- GS4.** Implement mulching and cover cropping methods.
- GS5.** Use soil test kits accurately.
- GS6.** Document soil conditions over seasons.
- GS7.** Plan crop rotation or plant selection based on soil type.
- GS8.** Identify soil-borne diseases and suggest remedies.
- GS9.** Perform trenching, tilling, and basic land preparation.
- GS10.** Maintain a soil health improvement schedule.

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Understanding the different quality parameters associated with soil testing, land preparation for Topiary gardening</i>	40	60	-	-
PC1. Soil testing methods.	15	20	-	-
PC2. Mineral content of soil samples.	10	20	-	-
PC3. Land preparation methods for topiary plant propagation.	15	20	-	-
NOS Total	40	60	-	-



Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	CUTM/AGR/N0802
NOS Name	Soil Management Practices
Sector	Agriculture
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Gardener
NSQF Level	4
Credits	3
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	22/10/2024
Next Review Date	21/10/2027
NSQC Clearance Date	22/10/2024

Qualification Pack

CUTM/AGR/N0803: Plants and Products for Topiary Making

Description

This NOS enables learners to identify suitable plants and complementary products for crafting various topiary designs. It focuses on matching plant characteristics to shaping techniques and understanding how support materials enhance artistic creation.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Includes the selection of topiary-friendly plants, knowledge of plant responses to shaping, and use of accessories and frames to aid design. Learners gain the ability to choose and work with living materials artistically and effectively.

Elements and Performance Criteria

Understanding the different quality parameters associated with selection of plants and different topiary artificial products for topiary making

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- | | |
|-------------|--|
| PC1. | Choosing of the plant species, according to the climatic conditions of the selected area. |
| PC2. | Selection of the resistant plants to common pests and diseases of the particular locality. |
| PC3. | Characteristics of topiary garden plants. |
| PC4. | Artificial products for topiary: dried moss grass, artificial plant/grass products. |

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** plant species best suited for different topiary styles.
- KU2.** foliage density and regeneration rate of ornamental plants.
- KU3.** Know the growth rate and response to pruning of selected plants.
- KU4.** about plant hardiness and resistance to pests.
- KU5.** seasonal cycles of topiary-friendly plants.
- KU6.** the common topiary shapes and the plant types best suited for each.
- KU7.** compatibility of plants with various climatic zones.
- KU8.** about the use of support structures for shaping.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:



Qualification Pack

- GS1.** Select appropriate plants for different topiary projects.
- GS2.** Match plant types to client or project requirements.
- GS3.** Create plant-product combinations for custom designs.
- GS4.** Use tools to trim and manipulate foliage to desired shape.
- GS5.** Maintain healthy plant growth post-installation.
- GS6.** Communicate choices and reasons to team or clients.
- GS7.** Handle plant material and design products with care.
- GS8.** Label and catalog plant varieties used.
- GS9.** Follow visual aesthetics and client briefs during implementation.

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Understanding the different quality parameters associated with selection of plants and different topiary artificial products for topiary making</i>	40	60	-	-
PC1. Choosing of the plant species, according to the climatic conditions of the selected area.	10	20	-	-
PC2. Selection of the resistant plants to common pests and diseases of the particular locality.	10	10	-	-
PC3. Characteristics of topiary garden plants.	10	10	-	-
PC4. Artificial products for topiary: dried moss grass, artificial plant/grass products.	10	20	-	-
NOS Total	40	60	-	-



Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	CUTM/AGR/N0803
NOS Name	Plants and Products for Topiary Making
Sector	Agriculture
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Gardener
NSQF Level	4
Credits	2
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	22/10/2024
Next Review Date	21/10/2027
NSQC Clearance Date	22/10/2024

Qualification Pack

CUTM/AGR/N0804: Plant Propagation Techniques

Description

This NOS equips learners with plant propagation knowledge essential for growing topiary plants. It focuses on the techniques and conditions required for generating healthy plant material for artistic shaping and landscaping.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Covers methods like cutting, layering, and grafting tools and care practices, and preparation for transplanting. Learners will be able to propagate and manage plant stock effectively, ensuring a sustainable supply for topiary creation.

Elements and Performance Criteria

Knowledge on plant propagation methods

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Understand different methods of propagation of plants for cost-effective plant production.
- PC2.** Understand the preservation, perpetuation and conservation of the desirable traits in plants through vegetative propagation.
- PC3.** Understand the asexual method/vegetative method like stem cuttings, root cuttings and leaf cutting methods of propagation.

Information about handling of fish and shellfish waste

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC4.** Understand detailed information on planting space.
- PC5.** Gain the knowledge on rapid plant multiplication by passing the lengthy seed germination process and time-saving cultivation.

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** sexual and asexual propagation methods.
- KU2.** the propagation by cuttings, layering, grafting, and division.
- KU3.** tools and materials used in propagation.
- KU4.** environmental conditions for propagation success.
- KU5.** about rooting hormones and their application.
- KU6.** how to select mother plants for propagation.
- KU7.** seed dormancy and germination processes.
- KU8.** proper handling of seedlings and young plants.
- KU9.** diseases and pests during propagation stages.



Qualification Pack

KU10. hygiene and sanitation in propagation.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Prepare propagation beds or containers.
- GS2.** Perform cutting, grafting, and layering correctly.
- GS3.** Monitor environmental conditions (moisture, light, temperature).
- GS4.** Label and track growth of propagated plants.
- GS5.** Maintain tool hygiene and personal safety.
- GS6.** Handle delicate plant material with care.
- GS7.** Create and maintain propagation records.
- GS8.** Evaluate rooting success and troubleshoot failure.
- GS9.** Select and transplant healthy saplings to grow beds.
- GS10.** Coordinate propagation schedules with planting cycles.

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Knowledge on plant propagation methods</i>	17	40	-	-
PC1. Understand different methods of propagation of plants for cost-effective plant production.	3	10	-	-
PC2. Understand the preservation, perpetuation and conservation of the desirable traits in plants through vegetative propagation.	5	10	-	-
PC3. Understand the asexual method/vegetative method like stem cuttings, root cuttings and leaf cutting methods of propagation.	9	20	-	-
<i>Information about handling of fish and shellfish waste</i>	13	30	-	-
PC4. Understand detailed information on planting space.	9	20	-	-
PC5. Gain the knowledge on rapid plant multiplication by passing the lengthy seed germination process and time-saving cultivation.	4	10	-	-
NOS Total	30	70	-	-



Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	CUTM/AGR/N0804
NOS Name	Plant Propagation Techniques
Sector	Agriculture
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Gardener
NSQF Level	4
Credits	2
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	22/10/2024
Next Review Date	21/10/2027
NSQF Clearance Date	22/10/2024

Qualification Pack

CUTM/AGR/N0805: Topiary Designing and Preservation

Description

This NOS focuses on the artistic and technical aspects of topiary design and its long-term maintenance. It equips learners to conceptualize, execute, and sustain decorative plant forms across various styles and settings.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Covers the process of shaping plants, using frames, design sketching, and maintaining plant health to retain form. Learners will gain skills in layout execution and preservation, ensuring long-term appeal and structural integrity of topiary designs.

Elements and Performance Criteria

Pruning techniques

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Steps to create structured and symmetrical designs of living plants into desired forms to add artistic expression in the garden.
- PC2.** Traditional and modern topiary shapes.
- PC3.** Practice on training and pruning techniques.
- PC4.** Understand the pruning periods/months.
- PC5.** Topiary gardens in India.

Maintenance of Topiary

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC6.** Understand the common mistakes in creating shapes.
- PC7.** Steps in maintaining topiary plants.
- PC8.** Learn about plant care and maintenance in different seasons.
- PC9.** watering in summer and winter.
- PC10.** Understand to sterilize the equipment before pruning to check spread of disease.
- PC11.** Learn the preservation and the long-term sustainability of topiary shapes through pruning practice.
- PC12.** Create educational opportunities for gardeners to maintain disease free plants.

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** design principles in topiary art (form, balance, symmetry).
- KU2.** various topiary shapes (spiral, ball, animal forms).
- KU3.** seasonal considerations for trimming and shaping.

Qualification Pack

- KU4.** plant response timelines post-trimming.
- KU5.** maintenance requirements post-installation.
- KU6.** about use of frames, guides, and templates.
- KU7.** lighting, spacing, and visibility in display.
- KU8.** how to preserve shape and form over time.
- KU9.** deterioration signs and corrective trimming.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Draft basic topiary designs on paper.
- GS2.** Trim and sculpt plants to match selected design.
- GS3.** Use templates and guides for consistent shaping.
- GS4.** Maintain form by scheduled trimming and training.
- GS5.** Monitor plant health during artistic transformation.
- GS6.** Communicate design concepts to clients or supervisors.
- GS7.** Make decisions on adjustments due to plant growth.
- GS8.** Store and clean tools after every use.
- GS9.** Apply preservation techniques like wrapping or weather shielding.
- GS10.** Document before-after stages for records or clients.

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Pruning techniques</i>	16	17	-	10
PC1. Steps to create structured and symmetrical designs of living plants into desired forms to add artistic expression in the garden.	5	3	-	2
PC2. Traditional and modern topiary shapes.	5	4	-	2
PC3. Practice on training and pruning techniques.	2	4	-	2
PC4. Understand the pruning periods/months.	2	3	-	2
PC5. Topiary gardens in India.	2	3	-	2
<i>Maintenance of Topiary</i>	14	23	-	20
PC6. Understand the common mistakes in creating shapes.	2	3	-	2
PC7. Steps in maintaining topiary plants.	3	3	-	3
PC8. Learn about plant care and maintenance in different seasons.	1	3	-	1
PC9. watering in summer and winter.	2	3	-	2
PC10. Understand to sterilize the equipment before pruning to check spread of disease.	2	4	-	5
PC11. Learn the preservation and the long-term sustainability of topiary shapes through pruning practice.	2	4	-	5
PC12. Create educational opportunities for gardeners to maintain disease free plants.	2	3	-	2
NOS Total	30	40	-	30



Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	CUTM/AGR/N0805
NOS Name	Topiary Designing and Preservation
Sector	Agriculture
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Gardener
NSQF Level	4
Credits	2
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	22/10/2024
Next Review Date	21/10/2027
NSQF Clearance Date	22/10/2024

Qualification Pack

CUTM/AGR/N0806: Yard Waste Management

Description

This NOS focuses on managing waste generated from gardening and topiary work. It emphasizes the importance of waste segregation, composting, and eco-friendly disposal methods to support sustainable gardening practices.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Includes yard waste collection, composting, safety, and compliance with disposal norms. Learners gain practical knowledge in waste minimization, recycling of organics, and environmental conservation through responsible garden waste management.

Elements and Performance Criteria

Clearing and recycling of yard waste

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Understand the significance of clearing of yard waste.
- PC2.** Learn separation of wood logs for other valuable use.
- PC3.** Yard waste drop off area selection.
- PC4.** Learn about recycling of yard waste by composting, equipment operation and safety consideration.

Personal safety skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC5.** Sanitize equipment, tools and machinery before and after use.
- PC6.** Learn about basic safety consideration before operation of all tools and machineries.

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** types of garden and yard waste (leaves, trimmings, branches).
- KU2.** segregation techniques: biodegradable vs non-biodegradable.
- KU3.** composting techniques for garden waste.
- KU4.** benefits of organic waste reuse.
- KU5.** local rules for garden waste disposal.
- KU6.** safety and hygiene in waste handling.
- KU7.** seasonal waste volumes and management planning.
- KU8.** basic equipment for waste collection and shredding.
- KU9.** reusable plant materials.
- KU10.** environmental impact of improper disposal.



Qualification Pack

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Collect and separate different yard waste types.
- GS2.** Operate compost bins and shredders safely.
- GS3.** Record quantity and type of waste collected.
- GS4.** Implement eco-friendly disposal methods.
- GS5.** Follow safety protocols while handling sharp or heavy waste.
- GS6.** Reduce, reuse, and recycle garden waste where feasible.
- GS7.** Communicate waste management procedures to team.
- GS8.** Create compost from organic waste.

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Clearing and recycling of yard waste</i>	20	50	-	-
PC1. Understand the significance of clearing of yard waste.	5	5	-	-
PC2. Learn separation of wood logs for other valuable use.	5	5	-	-
PC3. Yard waste drop off area selection.	5	20	-	-
PC4. Learn about recycling of yard waste by composting, equipment operation and safety consideration.	5	20	-	-
<i>Personal safety skills</i>	10	20	-	-
PC5. Sanitize equipment, tools and machinery before and after use.	5	10	-	-
PC6. Learn about basic safety consideration before operation of all tools and machineries.	5	10	-	-
NOS Total	30	70	-	-



Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	CUTM/AGR/N0806
NOS Name	Yard Waste Management
Sector	Agriculture
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Gardener
NSQF Level	4
Credits	2
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	22/10/2024
Next Review Date	21/10/2027
NSQC Clearance Date	22/10/2024

Qualification Pack

CUTM/VSQ/N7803: Maintain Health and Safety at Work Place.

Description

This NOS focuses on ensuring a safe and healthy working environment by promoting hazard identification, safe equipment handling, proper use of PPE, and adherence to workplace safety protocols. It involves assessing and mitigating risks, responding to emergencies, and minimizing environmental and workplace hazards to protect self, co-workers, and surroundings.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- The scope of this NOS includes performing regular safety checks, using safety gear, handling hazardous materials responsibly, following emergency procedures, and maintaining hygiene and cleanliness in the workplace. It aims to cultivate a culture of safety and environmental responsibility while reducing risk, injury, and workplace accidents.

Elements and Performance Criteria

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Undertaking basic safety checks before operation of all machinery and vehicles and hazards are reported to the appropriate supervisor
- PC2.** Work for which protective clothing or equipment is required is identified and the appropriate protective clothing or equipment is used in performing these duties in accordance with workplace policy.
- PC3.** Reading and understanding the hazards of use and contamination mentioned on the labels of pesticides/fumigants etc
- PC4.** Assessing the risks prior to performing manual handling jobs and work according to currently recommended safe practice.
- PC5.** Use equipment and materials safely and correctly and return the same to designated storage when not in use
- PC6.** Dispose of waste safely and correctly in a designated area
- PC7.** Recognize risks to bystanders and take action to reduce risk associated with jobs in the workplace
- PC8.** Perform your work in a manner, which minimizes environmental damage all procedures and work instructions for controlling risk are followed closely.
- PC9.** Report any accidents, incidents or problems immediately to an appropriate person and take necessary immediate action to reduce further danger.
- PC10.** Follow procedures for dealing with accidents, fires and emergencies, including communicating location and directions to emergency.
- PC11.** Follow emergency procedures to company standard / workplace requirements

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

Qualification Pack

- KU1.** Basic safety checks and pre-operational inspection procedures for machinery and vehicles.
- KU2.** Importance of reporting hazards to supervisors immediately.
- KU3.** Identification and correct use of personal protective equipment (PPE).
- KU4.** Hazard symbols, warning labels, and safe handling instructions on pesticides/fumigants.
- KU5.** Risk assessment techniques for manual handling and other workplace tasks.
- KU6.** Safe usage, handling, and storage of tools, materials, and equipment.
- KU7.** Proper methods of waste segregation and disposal.
- KU8.** Identifying workplace risks to others and preventive action planning.
- KU9.** Environmental protection procedures and pollution control practices.
- KU10.** Emergency response protocols including fire, accident, and evacuation procedures.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Perform routine safety inspections and hazard identification confidently.
- GS2.** Demonstrate use of PPE according to task-specific needs.
- GS3.** Interpret chemical hazard labels and apply safety practices accordingly.
- GS4.** Conduct basic risk assessments for manual work operations.
- GS5.** Operate tools and equipment safely, and store them properly after use.
- GS6.** Segregate and dispose of waste in compliance with workplace guidelines.
- GS7.** Monitor surroundings to identify risks to co-workers and intervene appropriately.
- GS8.** Follow environmentally responsible practices during work execution.
- GS9.** Report incidents promptly and initiate basic emergency response actions.
- GS10.** Respond effectively to accidents and emergencies as per protocol.

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
	20	30	-	-
PC1. Undertaking basic safety checks before operation of all machinery and vehicles and hazards are reported to the appropriate supervisor	-	-	-	-
PC2. Work for which protective clothing or equipment is required is identified and the appropriate protective clothing or equipment is used in performing these duties in accordance with workplace policy.	2	3	-	-
PC3. Reading and understanding the hazards of use and contamination mentioned on the labels of pesticides/fumigants etc	2	3	-	-
PC4. Assessing the risks prior to performing manual handling jobs and work according to currently recommended safe practice.	2	3	-	-
PC5. Use equipment and materials safely and correctly and return the same to designated storage when not in use	2	3	-	-
PC6. Dispose of waste safely and correctly in a designated area	2	3	-	-
PC7. Recognize risks to bystanders and take action to reduce risk associated with jobs in the workplace	2	3	-	-
PC8. Perform your work in a manner, which minimizes environmental damage all procedures and work instructions for controlling risk are followed closely.	2	3	-	-
PC9. Report any accidents, incidents or problems immediately to an appropriate person and take necessary immediate action to reduce further danger.	2	3	-	-
PC10. Follow procedures for dealing with accidents, fires and emergencies, including communicating location and directions to emergency.	2	3	-	-

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC11. Follow emergency procedures to company standard / workplace requirements	2	3	-	-
NOS Total	20	30	-	-



Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	CUTM/VSQ/N7803
NOS Name	Maintain Health and Safety at Work Place.
Sector	Cross Sectoral
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Health and Safety
NSQF Level	4
Credits	1
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	22/10/2024
Next Review Date	21/10/2027
NSQC Clearance Date	22/10/2024



Qualification Pack

DGT/VSQ/N0101: Employability Skills (30 Hours)

Description

This unit is about employability skills, Constitutional values, becoming a professional in the 21st Century, digital, financial, and legal literacy, diversity and Inclusion, English and communication skills, customer service, entrepreneurship, and apprenticeship, getting ready for jobs and career development.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Introduction to Employability Skills
- Constitutional values - Citizenship
- Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century
- Basic English Skills
- Communication Skills
- Diversity & Inclusion
- Financial and Legal Literacy
- Essential Digital Skills
- Entrepreneurship
- Customer Service
- Getting ready for Apprenticeship & Jobs

Elements and Performance Criteria

Introduction to Employability Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC1. understand the significance of employability skills in meeting the job requirements

Constitutional values – Citizenship

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC2. identify constitutional values, civic rights, duties, personal values and ethics and environmentally sustainable practices

Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC3. explain 21st Century Skills such as Self-Awareness, Behavior Skills, Positive attitude, self-motivation, problem-solving, creative thinking, time management, social and cultural awareness, emotional awareness, continuous learning mindset etc.

Basic English Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC4. speak with others using some basic English phrases or sentences

Communication Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC5. follow good manners while communicating with others

PC6. work with others in a team

Qualification Pack

Diversity & Inclusion

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC7. communicate and behave appropriately with all genders and PwD

PC8. report any issues related to sexual harassment

Financial and Legal Literacy

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC9. use various financial products and services safely and securely

PC10. calculate income, expenses, savings etc.

PC11. approach the concerned authorities for any exploitation as per legal rights and laws

Essential Digital Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC12. operate digital devices and use its features and applications securely and safely

PC13. use internet and social media platforms securely and safely

Entrepreneurship

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC14. identify and assess opportunities for potential business

PC15. identify sources for arranging money and associated financial and legal challenges

Customer Service

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC16. identify different types of customers

PC17. identify customer needs and address them appropriately

PC18. follow appropriate hygiene and grooming standards

Getting ready for apprenticeship & Jobs

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC19. create a basic biodata

PC20. search for suitable jobs and apply

PC21. identify and register apprenticeship opportunities as per requirement

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

KU1. need for employability skills

KU2. various constitutional and personal values

KU3. different environmentally sustainable practices and their importance

KU4. Twenty first (21st) century skills and their importance

KU5. how to use basic spoken English language

KU6. Do and dont of effective communication

KU7. inclusivity and its importance

KU8. different types of disabilities and appropriate communication and behaviour towards PwD

KU9. different types of financial products and services



Qualification Pack

- KU10.** how to compute income and expenses
- KU11.** importance of maintaining safety and security in financial transactions
- KU12.** different legal rights and laws
- KU13.** how to operate digital devices and applications safely and securely
- KU14.** ways to identify business opportunities
- KU15.** types of customers and their needs
- KU16.** how to apply for a job and prepare for an interview
- KU17.** apprenticeship scheme and the process of registering on apprenticeship portal

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** communicate effectively using appropriate language
- GS2.** behave politely and appropriately with all
- GS3.** perform basic calculations
- GS4.** solve problems effectively
- GS5.** be careful and attentive at work
- GS6.** use time effectively
- GS7.** maintain hygiene and sanitisation to avoid infection

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Introduction to Employability Skills</i>	1	1	-	-
PC1. understand the significance of employability skills in meeting the job requirements	-	-	-	-
<i>Constitutional values – Citizenship</i>	1	1	-	-
PC2. identify constitutional values, civic rights, duties, personal values and ethics and environmentally sustainable practices	-	-	-	-
<i>Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century</i>	1	3	-	-
PC3. explain 21st Century Skills such as Self-Awareness, Behavior Skills, Positive attitude, self-motivation, problem-solving, creative thinking, time management, social and cultural awareness, emotional awareness, continuous learning mindset etc.	-	-	-	-
<i>Basic English Skills</i>	2	3	-	-
PC4. speak with others using some basic English phrases or sentences	-	-	-	-
<i>Communication Skills</i>	1	1	-	-
PC5. follow good manners while communicating with others	-	-	-	-
PC6. work with others in a team	-	-	-	-
<i>Diversity & Inclusion</i>	1	1	-	-
PC7. communicate and behave appropriately with all genders and PwD	-	-	-	-
PC8. report any issues related to sexual harassment	-	-	-	-
<i>Financial and Legal Literacy</i>	3	4	-	-
PC9. use various financial products and services safely and securely	-	-	-	-

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC10. calculate income, expenses, savings etc.	-	-	-	-
PC11. approach the concerned authorities for any exploitation as per legal rights and laws	-	-	-	-
<i>Essential Digital Skills</i>	4	6	-	-
PC12. operate digital devices and use its features and applications securely and safely	-	-	-	-
PC13. use internet and social media platforms securely and safely	-	-	-	-
<i>Entrepreneurship</i>	3	5	-	-
PC14. identify and assess opportunities for potential business	-	-	-	-
PC15. identify sources for arranging money and associated financial and legal challenges	-	-	-	-
<i>Customer Service</i>	2	2	-	-
PC16. identify different types of customers	-	-	-	-
PC17. identify customer needs and address them appropriately	-	-	-	-
PC18. follow appropriate hygiene and grooming standards	-	-	-	-
<i>Getting ready for apprenticeship & Jobs</i>	1	3	-	-
PC19. create a basic biodata	-	-	-	-
PC20. search for suitable jobs and apply	-	-	-	-
PC21. identify and register apprenticeship opportunities as per requirement	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	20	30	-	-

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	DGT/VSQ/N0101
NOS Name	Employability Skills (30 Hours)
Sector	Cross Sectoral
Sub-Sector	Professional Skills
Occupation	Employability
NSQF Level	2
Credits	1
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	12/03/2026
Next Review Date	12/03/2029
NSQC Clearance Date	12/03/2026

Assessment Guidelines and Assessment Weightage

Assessment Guidelines

1. Assessment System Overview:

- Batches assigned to the assessment agencies for conducting the assessment on SIDH or email
- Assessment agencies send the assessment confirmation to TP looping AB/AA to accept in SIDH
- Assessment agency deploys the ToA certified Assessor for executing the assessment
- AB monitors the assessment process & records

2. Testing Environment:

- Check the Assessment location, date and time
- If the batch size is more than 30, then there should be 2 Assessors.
- Check that the allotted time to the candidates to complete Theory & Practical Assessment is correct.



Qualification Pack

3. Assessment Quality Assurance levels/Framework:

- Question bank is created by the Subject Matter Experts (SME) are verified by the AB
- Questions are mapped to the specified assessment criteria.
- Assessor must be ToA certified & trainer must be ToT Certified

4. Types of evidence or evidence-gathering protocol:

- Time-stamped & geotagged reporting of the assessor from assessment location.
- Centre photographs with signboards and scheme specific branding
- Video Call verification/online proctoring will be done during the assessment from AB.

5. Method of verification or validation:

- Surprise visit to the assessment location

6. Minimum Percentage Required

- 70% overall to pass.
- Minimum 70% in each NOS

7. Reassessment: Candidates failing the assessment will be given one opportunity for reassessment after additional training.

8. Assessor Details: ToA Certified Assessor with relevant experience.

Minimum Aggregate Passing % at QP Level : 70

(Please note: Every Trainee should score a minimum aggregate passing percentage as specified above, to successfully clear the Qualification Pack assessment.)

Minimum Passing % at NOS Level: 60

(Please note: A Trainee must score the minimum percentage for each NOS separately as well as on the QP as a whole.)

Qualification Pack

Assessment Weightage

Compulsory NOS

National Occupational Standards	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks	Total Marks	Weightage
CUTM/AGR/N0801.Introduction to plants used in Topiary Gardening and Gardening Tools	30	40	-	30	100	10
CUTM/AGR/N0802.Soil Management Practices	40	60	-	-	100	10
CUTM/AGR/N0803.Plants and Products for Topiary Making	40	60	-	-	100	10
CUTM/AGR/N0804.Plant Propagation Techniques	30	70	-	-	100	10
CUTM/AGR/N0805.Topiary Designing and Preservation	30	40	-	30	100	20
CUTM/AGR/N0806.Yard Waste Management	30	70	-	-	100	20
CUTM/VSQ/N7803.Maintain Health and Safety at Work Place.	20	30	-	-	50	10
DGT/VSQ/N0101.Employability Skills (30 Hours)	20	30	-	-	50	10
Total	240	400	-	60	700	100



Qualification Pack

Acronyms

NOS	National Occupational Standard(s)
NSQF	National Skills Qualifications Framework
QP	Qualifications Pack
TVET	Technical and Vocational Education and Training

Qualification Pack

Glossary

Sector	Sector is a conglomeration of different business operations having similar business and interests. It may also be defined as a distinct subset of the economy whose components share similar characteristics and interests.
Sub-sector	Sub-sector is derived from a further breakdown based on the characteristics and interests of its components.
Occupation	Occupation is a set of job roles, which perform similar/ related set of functions in an industry.
Job role	Job role defines a unique set of functions that together form a unique employment opportunity in an organisation.
Occupational Standards (OS)	OS specify the standards of performance an individual must achieve when carrying out a function in the workplace, together with the Knowledge and Understanding (KU) they need to meet that standard consistently. Occupational Standards are applicable both in the Indian and global contexts.
Performance Criteria (PC)	Performance Criteria (PC) are statements that together specify the standard of performance required when carrying out a task.
National Occupational Standards (NOS)	NOS are occupational standards which apply uniquely in the Indian context.
Qualifications Pack (QP)	QP comprises the set of OS, together with the educational, training and other criteria required to perform a job role. A QP is assigned a unique qualifications pack code.
Unit Code	Unit code is a unique identifier for an Occupational Standard, which is denoted by an 'N'
Unit Title	Unit title gives a clear overall statement about what the incumbent should be able to do.
Description	Description gives a short summary of the unit content. This would be helpful to anyone searching on a database to verify that this is the appropriate OS they are looking for.
Scope	Scope is a set of statements specifying the range of variables that an individual may have to deal with in carrying out the function which have a critical impact on quality of performance required.

Qualification Pack

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)	Knowledge and Understanding (KU) are statements which together specify the technical, generic, professional and organisational specific knowledge that an individual needs in order to perform to the required standard.
Organisational Context	Organisational context includes the way the organisation is structured and how it operates, including the extent of operative knowledge managers have of their relevant areas of responsibility.
Technical Knowledge	Technical knowledge is the specific knowledge needed to accomplish specific designated responsibilities.
Core Skills/ Generic Skills (GS)	Core skills or Generic Skills (GS) are a group of skills that are the key to learning and working in today's world. These skills are typically needed in any work environment in today's world. These skills are typically needed in any work environment. In the context of the OS, these include communication related skills that are applicable to most job roles.
Electives	Electives are NOS/set of NOS that are identified by the sector as contributive to specialization in a job role. There may be multiple electives within a QP for each specialized job role. Trainees must select at least one elective for the successful completion of a QP with Electives.
Options	Options are NOS/set of NOS that are identified by the sector as additional skills. There may be multiple options within a QP. It is not mandatory to select any of the options to complete a QP with Options.